18.11 Alcohol Withdrawal*

Assessment	Nursing Diagnosis	Plan / Expected Outcome	Nursing Interventions	Evaluation
Subjective • "My hands shake and I see insects on the wall." **Objective** • Tremor, sweating, HR 118/min • Visual hallucinations • Last drink 48 hours ago	**ACTUAL** Acute substance withdrawal syndrome related to abrupt cessation of alcohol as evidenced by tremor, tachycardia and hallucinations.	• Gets through withdrawal without seizures or delirium.	• Score withdrawal with a validated scale such as CIWA-Ar. • Give symptom-triggered benzodiazepines as prescribed. • Give thiamine before glucose, as prescribed. • Follow vital signs and consciousness.	• Considered met when withdrawal is completed safely.
Subjective • "There are people in my room." **Objective** • Disoriented at night • Hallucinating	**ACTUAL** Acute confusion related to alcohol withdrawal as evidenced by disorientation and hallucinations.	• Oriented within 72 hours.	• Keep the room well lit and quiet. • Reorient him often. • Observe him closely.	• Goal reached once he is oriented.
Subjective *No specific complaint* **Objective** • Heavy drinking • Has had withdrawal seizures	**RISK** Risk for physical injury as evidenced by risk factors: withdrawal seizures and confusion.	• No injury.	• Put seizure precautions in place. • Put fall precautions in place. • Give benzodiazepine according to the score, as prescribed.	• Met if no injury occurs.

* **References for this care plan:** [31], [35], [57], [122]. Full entries are listed in the References section of the CPMN book.